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Unjust, Furtive, Sleuth, Plethora, Gloss

1. Unjust (अत्याचारी / अन्यायी) (Adjective) (uhn-juhst) (Critical / Negative Tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Not based on or behaving according to what is morally right and fair.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जो नैतिक रूप से सही और न्यायसंगत न हो।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *in-* (not) → **Old French** *injuste* → Middle English *unjust* → **Modern English** *unjust*.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** unfair, inequitable, wrongful
 - **Antonyms:** just, fair, equitable
- **Connotation:** Negative — carries moral condemnation and ethical disapproval.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A teacher giving high grades only to their favorite students, ignoring merit.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In any functioning democracy, the perception of justice is crucial. When laws are applied selectively, the system risks being perceived as unjust. This perception erodes public trust and encourages dissent. Citizens begin questioning the motives behind legal decisions, suspecting favoritism or discrimination. History provides numerous examples where unjust governance has led to uprisings or civil unrest. Whether in corporate policies, educational grading systems, or government actions, injustice creates a ripple effect that undermines stability. Recognizing and correcting unjust practices is, therefore, not only a moral imperative but also a strategic necessity for societal cohesion.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** The law was deemed unjust by human rights activists. (कानून को मानवाधिकार कार्यकर्ताओं ने अन्यायी माना।)
-  **Incorrect:** This cake is unjustly delicious. (Incorrect — moral fairness doesn't apply to taste.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Think *un-* (not) + *just* (fair) — anything morally wrong, discriminatory, or inequitable fits here. Avoid using it for neutral or subjective preferences like flavors or hobbies. This word works best in contexts involving ethics, law, morality, or fairness.

- **Example + Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- *The unjust decision angered the public.* (अन्यायी निर्णय ने जनता को क्रोधित कर दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Subject: *The unjust decision* (noun phrase with adjective modifier "unjust")
 - Predicate: *angered the public* (verb + object)
 - Structure: [NP + VP + NP]

- **Common Collocations:**

- unjust law, unjust treatment, unjust punishment, unjust system

- **My Statement:**

- The unjust law faced dissent from the public, eroding trust in the governing institution.
- The system they created is unjust for already miserable individuals.

- We received unjust treatment in the foreign country, which damaged its international image.
- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

2. Furtive (गुप्त / चोरी-छिपे) (*Adjective*) (*fur-tiv*) (*Suspicious / Negative Tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** Attempting to avoid notice or attention, typically because of guilt or a belief that discovery would lead to trouble.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** छुपकर या चोरी-छिपे किया गया, ताकि पकड़े जाने से बचा जा सके।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *furtivus* (stolen) → **Old French *furtif*** → English *furtive*.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** stealthy, surreptitious, covert
 - **Antonyms:** open, overt, candid
- **Connotation:** Negative — suggests secrecy with possible wrongdoing.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person quickly slipping a book into their bag without paying.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In espionage narratives, the role of the spy often hinges on their ability to remain unnoticed. Furtive movements, whispered exchanges, and coded messages all serve as hallmarks of clandestine operations. In psychology, such behavior may indicate guilt or anxiety, prompting suspicion. The word "furtive" captures not only the physical act of concealment but also the underlying intent. From corporate boardrooms to political negotiations, a furtive glance or side conversation can shift the dynamics of trust.

Detecting such subtle cues is a skill valued in investigative journalism and law enforcement.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** She cast a furtive glance at the clock. (उसने घड़ी की ओर चोरी-छिपे नज़र डाली।)
-  **Incorrect:** The mountain looked furtive at sunset. (Incorrect — mountains don't act with intent.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Associate *furtive* with “fugitive” — both suggest avoiding being caught. If someone looks like they don't want to be noticed, think “furtive.” Great for describing secret glances, movements, or conversations. Avoid using it for lifeless objects unless metaphorical.

- **Example + Low-Level Grammatical Structure:**

- *They exchanged furtive whispers during the meeting.* (उन्होंने बैठक के दौरान चोरी-छिपे बातें की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Subject: *They* (pronoun)
 - Predicate: *exchanged furtive whispers during the meeting* (verb + object + prepositional phrase)

- **Common Collocations:**

- furtive glance, furtive smile, furtive movement, furtive behavior

- **My Statement:**

- I understood her intentions from her furtive glance.
- In a mall, a person with furtive behaviour was caught with the help of surveillance cameras.
- His furtive smile was caught on camera, which nobody noticed directly.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

3. Sleuth (जासूस) (Noun & Verb) (slooth) (Neutral, slightly formal)

- **Meaning (English):** A person who investigates and solves mysteries; to act as a detective.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जासूस; कोई व्यक्ति जो रहस्यों की जाँच और समाधान करता है।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old Norse *slóð* → **Middle English *slouthe* (track, trail)** → Modern English *sleuth* (detective).
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** detective, investigator, gumshoe
 - **Antonyms:** suspect, criminal
- **Connotation:** Neutral, but leans toward intelligence and mystery.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Imagine a man in a trench coat and hat, magnifying glass in hand, looking at muddy footprints in the rain.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In investigative journalism, a reporter often takes on the role of a sleuth, meticulously piecing together clues to reveal hidden truths. This sleuthing is not just about following leads but also verifying sources, identifying patterns, and understanding human behavior. For instance, a journalist may trace financial irregularities through public

records, interviews, and on-the-ground observations. The patience and persistence required for sleuth work mirror those of a detective solving a criminal case. Such investigative efforts often lead to uncovering corruption, fraud, or systemic flaws in governance, thus contributing significantly to societal transparency and justice.

- **Correct & Incorrect Usage:**

-  *The police hired a sleuth to find the missing documents.* (पुलिस ने लापता दस्तावेज़ ढूँढने के लिए एक जासूस रखा।)
-  *He is a sleuthing fast.* (Wrong grammar – should be "He is sleuthing fast.")

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Connect "sleuth" with "sloth" (slow animal). A good sleuth takes things slow, examining every clue. Sloth = slow → Sleuth = slow but smart investigation.

- **Example & Detailed Structure:**

- The private sleuth uncovered the truth behind the fraud. (निजी जासूस ने धोखाधड़ी के पीछे की सच्चाई उजागर की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Subject: *The private sleuth* (Noun Phrase)
 - Verb: *uncovered* (Past Simple)
 - Object: *the truth behind the fraud* (Noun Phrase)

- **Common Collocations:**

- amateur sleuth, private sleuth, cyber sleuth, keen sleuth

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**
 - He is an amateur sleuth in this industry. Would you mind if I call him?
 - She hired a private sleuth to investigate the matter.
 - Cyber sleuths are not hard to find these days.
- **(VERB)**
 - They sleuthed on their competitors for days before coming up with a winning solution.
 - The government prevented every attempt to sleuth on them.
 - Drones were arranged to sleuth on civilians involved in the violence.

4. Plethora (अधिकता) (Noun) (pleh-thuh-ruh) (Formal)

- **Meaning (English):** An excessive amount or overabundance of something.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** अत्यधिक मात्रा, भरमार।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Greek *plēthōra* (fullness) → **Latin *plethōra*** → Old French *plethore* → **Modern English *plethora***.
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** abundance, profusion, surplus
 - **Antonyms:** scarcity, paucity
- **Connotation:** Usually neutral, but can imply negativity if excess is undesirable.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Imagine a dining table overflowing with food that no one could possibly finish.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

The digital age has brought a plethora of information at our fingertips. While this abundance has democratized access to knowledge, it also poses challenges in discerning credible sources from misleading ones. For researchers, the plethora of data means more opportunities but also more responsibility to filter and evaluate. In education, this wealth of material can enhance learning experiences, yet without proper

curation, it can overwhelm students. Thus, managing a plethora requires critical thinking, prioritization, and effective organizational skills to ensure that the benefits of abundance outweigh its potential downsides.

- **Correct & Incorrect Usage:**

-  *There is a plethora of options to choose from.* (चुनने के लिए विकल्पों की भरमार है।)
-  *I have plethora of books.* (Missing article – should be “a plethora of books.”)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Think “plenty + extra” = plethora. When there’s not just enough but too much, that’s a plethora.

- **Example & Detailed Structure:**

- The festival offered a plethora of cultural experiences. (त्योहार ने सांस्कृतिक अनुभवों की भरमार पेश की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Subject: *The festival*
 - Verb: *offered* (Past Simple)
 - Object: *a plethora of cultural experiences*

- **Common Collocations:**

- a plethora of choices, plethora of opportunities, plethora of problems

- **My Statement:**

- The internet offers a plethora of resources that seem impossible to fully grasp.
- We were supposed to have a plethora of opportunities after graduating.
- By making several irrational deviations in our life, we invite a plethora of problems.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

5. Gloss (चमक / टीका) (*Noun & Verb*) (*gloss*) (*Neutral, can be positive or negative*)

- **Meaning (English):**

- (Noun) A shine or polish on a surface.
- (Noun) A brief explanation or interpretation of a word or phrase.
- (Verb) To give a misleading or superficial explanation; to make something appear more attractive than it really is.

- **Meaning (Hindi):**

- चमक, चमकदार परत।
- टिप्पणी, व्याख्या।

- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**

- Latin *glossa* (tongue, language) → **Old French *glose*** → Middle English *glose* → **Modern English *gloss***.

- **Synonym + Antonym:**

- **Synonyms:** shine, explanation, polish, sugarcoat
- **Antonyms:** dullness, truth, bluntness

- **Connotation:** Neutral in literal sense; slightly negative when implying concealment of truth.

- **Pictorial Scenario:** Imagine a wooden table with a perfect, shiny finish hiding the cracks beneath.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In marketing, companies often gloss over the drawbacks of their products, focusing instead on the appealing features. This “glossing” can be seen in advertisements that highlight benefits without addressing limitations. However, gloss is not inherently deceptive—academic books may include a gloss to clarify difficult terms for readers. In craftsmanship, a high gloss finish adds elegance and aesthetic appeal. Therefore, the context determines whether gloss serves as a helpful aid or as a superficial layer concealing flaws.

- **Correct & Incorrect Usage:**

-  *The report had a gloss to make it appear more favorable.* (रिपोर्ट में एक चमक थी जिससे यह और अनुकूल लग रही थी।)
-  *She gloss the wood.* (Wrong tense – should be “She glossed the wood.”)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Think of lip gloss—it makes lips look shiny and appealing. The same word applies to surfaces and to ideas when someone tries to make them look better than they are.

- **Example & Detailed Structure:**

- The politician tried to gloss over the controversy. (राजनेता ने विवाद को छिपाने की कोशिश की।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Subject: *The politician*
 - Verb: *tried* (Past Simple)
 - Infinitive Phrase: *to gloss over the controversy*
- **Common Collocations:**
 - high gloss finish, gloss over, lip gloss, gloss paint
- **My Statement:**
 - **(NOUN)**
 - The gloss of the glass was reflecting on my face, causing irritation.
 - The gloss of the technical terms has to be listed on the first page of the book
 - I bought a new lip gloss for myself as well as for you.
 - **(VERB)**
 - The ads were trying to gloss over the flaws in their product.
 - He glossed over the truth in the interview, stating everything false about his brand.
 - The glossed-over narrative may have misled a lot of youth in the country.
- **My Notes:**
 - **NOTE: Gloss as Verb**
 - "gloss" as a verb is tricky because it's often used in specific idioms or structures like "gloss over" (meaning to cover up, downplay, or present something deceptively positively)
 - If you use just "gloss" without "over", it usually means to add a shiny finish or to provide a brief explanation.